

Electricity Distribution Industry (*EDICON*) 2026

1st Annual Conference of



Theme : Viable Future Ready Discoms

All India Discoms Association (AIDA) was set up in December 2024 as a non-profit charitable society. It has now 51 utilities as its members. AIDA is now recognised as a unique platform representing the reasoned and collective viewpoint of distribution utilities in India. Its membership and the Executive Council consist of distribution utilities alone. It is working tirelessly for effective policy and regulatory advocacy, capacity building in discoms, and collaboration for sharing best practices and standardisation of equipment specification for better quality and competitive prices. AIDA aims at world class distribution performance for larger welfare of common electricity consumers.



21st and 22nd Jan, 2026

SCOPE auditorium, New Delhi



[WWW. aida-india.org](http://www.aida-india.org)

Conference on Electricity Distribution Industry, 2026 AIDA 21st and 22nd January, 2026

Introduction and Context

All India Discoms Association was set up in December 2024 as a non-profit charitable society. It has now 51 utilities as its members. AIDA is now recognized as a unique platform representing the reasoned and collective viewpoint of distribution utilities in India. Its membership and the Executive Council consist of distribution utilities alone. It is working tirelessly for effective policy and regulatory advocacy, capacity building in discoms, and collaboration for sharing best practices and standardisation of equipment specification for better quality and competitive prices. AIDA aims at world class distribution performance for larger welfare of common electricity consumers.

On completion of its first year of inspiring existence, AIDA has decided to organise a two-day conference in 23rd and 24th January, 2026 for bringing together policy makers, regulators, think tanks, industry participants, its collaborating partner organisations and all its member discoms for meaningful in-person deliberations on identified key topics highly relevant to improvement in performance of distribution utilities. It will be institutionalised as an annual event organised by and participated by most of the discoms in India.

Objectives

The conference has been structured keeping in view the following objectives:

- To disseminate and showcase the work done by AIDA in the year 2025.
- To connect with all relevant stakeholders for identifying the possible action areas for improvement in the performance of distribution utilities.
- To recognise the innovative work being done by the discoms for inspiring other members to also innovate and excel.

Expected Outcomes: AIDA is looking forward to the following outcomes from the conference:

1. Wider appreciation of the role being played by AIDA enabling it to become more effective in policy and regulatory advocacy.
2. Deeper understanding of the issues through deliberations and crystallising new action areas for AIDA going forward.
3. Identifying new opportunities for collaboration with stakeholder organisations and think tanks.
4. Presentation of AIDA Awards 2025 for good work being done by discoms will foster peer group learnings and create an environment for moving towards excellence.

Day 1- 21st January, 2026

CONFERENCE - INAUGURATION

09:45 ~ 11:10 am

09:00 ~ 09:45	Registration and Badge Collection
09:45 ~ 11:15	Welcome Address by Shri Alok Kumar (AIDA-Director General) Opening Address by Shri Lokesh Chandra (AIDA- President) Special Address by guest of honor Special Address by guest of honor Special Address by guest of honor Screening of AIDA's Film Launch of 'India Discoms: 2025' (AIDA's Annual Report) Launch of Joint Report of AIDA & REC study- Dynamics of Tariff and True -up Mechanisms: Insights from Tariff order and Regulations Presentation of AIDA Annual Awards 2025 Inaugural Address by chief guest of honor- Minister's Speech Vote of Thanks by General Secretary of AIDA: Dr. Ashish Kumar Goel
Session Coordinator: Sudhir Kumar, RO, AIDA, 9555232966, ro@aida-india.org Garima Maurya, RO2, AIDA, 9565950184, ro2@aida-india.org	

11:10 – 11: 25 am Welcome Tea

Technical Sessions

SESSION 1: Viability of DISCOMs and Cost-Reflective Tariff

11:45 – 13:00 pm

Session Background

DISCOM viability is the foundation of India's entire power sector. However, major gaps exist between audited accounts, regulatory accounts, subsidy payments, tariff design, and actual field implementation. Tariffs are not fully cost-reflective, losses remain high, working-capital shortages persist, and integration of renewable energy is increasing system costs. To ensure reliable, affordable, and sustainable power, India must reform tariff structures, improve financial discipline, strengthen data quality, adopt new technologies (AI/ML, forecasting, smart metering), and streamline regulatory processes. This session will focus on practical ways to make DISCOMs financially strong and future-ready.

Discussion Points

1. Audited vs Regulatory Accounts – Huge gap; need one unified cost basis for tariff-setting.
2. Cost-Reflective Tariffs – WPI-linked tariff revision, timely true-up, simpler tariff structure.
3. Financial Discipline – Timely subsidy release, clearing government dues, reducing litigation.
4. Regulatory Assets (RA) – Limit RA, clear existing RA in 3–7 years, avoid future build-up.
5. Smart Metering & Data Quality – Accurate energy accounting, consumer trust, faster rollout.
6. Power Purchase Cost Reduction – Better forecasting, AI/ML, improved procurement planning.
7. Renewable Integration Costs – Use storage, demand response, localized RE to manage variability.
8. Capacity Building – National fund for AI, analytics, forecasting, cyber security.
9. Governance & Accountability – Enforce billing/collection norms; replicate Kerala/Tripura models.
10. Transmission Planning – DISCOM participation, TBCB for intra-state transmission.

Chair

PFC

Presentation I

World Bank

Presentation II

Power Finance Corporation (PFC)

Moderator

ED REC, Panel Discussion (30 min) and Q&A (15 min)

Panelists

TPNODL, GUVNL, Karnataka (SERC), World Bank, CERC

Closing Remarks by Chair of the session

Session coordinator: S. N. Kalita Director Regulatory Affairs, AIDA, 7002550205, dirra@aida-india.org

Sudhir Kumar, RO, AIDA, 9555232966, ro@aida-india.org

SESSION 2: Leveraging Smart Meters and Data Analytics

13:00 – 14:15 pm

Session Background

Smart meters provide real-time, accurate data on consumer usage, load patterns, tampering, and power quality. This data helps DISCOMs reduce losses, improve billing and revenue, manage demand, plan networks better, and offer transparent, reliable services to consumers. It is a key enabler for modern, digital, and future-ready power distribution.

Discussion Points

1. Accurate billing & better revenue.
2. AT&C loss reduction through theft/tamper detection.
3. Demand Response and Management
4. Load forecasting and demand management.
5. Faster outage detection and improved reliability.
6. Consumer empowerment through real-time usage data.
7. Network planning using consumption patterns.

Enabling rooftop solar, EV charging, and dynamic tariffs.

Chair	JS Distribution (MoP)
Presentation I	CEEW
Presentation II	IES/
Presentation III	JPAL
Moderator	President ISGF- Panel Discussion (30 min) and Q&A (15 min)
Panelists	SBPDCL, Adani Electricity (Mumbai), CEEW, Bidgley, Secure Meters

Closing Remarks by Chair of the Session

Session coordinator: Khajan Bardwaj, Director Technical, 7836810510, dirtech@aida-india.org
Garima Maurya, RO, AIDA, 9565950184, ro2@aida-india.org

14:15 – 15:00 Networking Lunch

SESSION 3: Challenges in Renewable Energy Integration

15:00 – 16:15 pm

Session Background

As solar and wind capacity grows, the grid faces new technical and operational challenges. Renewable energy is variable, weather-dependent, and often concentrated in specific regions, which makes balancing supply and demand harder. To ensure reliability, the grid needs flexibility, storage, better forecasting, and stronger transmission systems. Managing this transition while keeping power affordable and stable is a major challenge for DISCOMs and system operators.

Discussion Points

1. Intermittency – Solar/wind fluctuate with weather and time of day.
2. Forecasting issues – Inaccurate predictions lead to imbalance and penalties.
3. Grid stability – Sudden ramp-up/ramp-down affects frequency and voltage.
4. Transmission constraints – RE-rich areas often lack strong evacuation lines.
5. Storage requirement – Need BESS/pumped hydro for peak shifting and balancing.
6. Curtailment – Oversupply in certain hours leads to RE wastage.
7. Balancing cost – Higher need for reserves and flexible thermal.
8. Role of DISCOMs – Scheduling, settlement, and managing variability.

Chair	Chairperson (CEA)
Presentation I	TERI
Presentation II	ISGF
Moderator	Director General of AIDA, Panel Discussion (30 min) and Q&A (15 min)
Panelists	Energy Department of Rajasthan Pravah, TNPDC, PXIL, SECI

Concluding Remarks by Chair of the Session

Session coordinator: S. N. Kalita Director Regulatory Affairs, AIDA, 7002550205, dirra@aida-india.org
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16:15 – 16:30 pm Tea Break

SESSION 4: Interventions for Improving Reliability of Supply

16:30 – 17:45 pm

Session Background

Reliable electricity supply depends on strong networks, efficient operations, and timely fault detection. As demand grows and more renewable energy connects to the grid, DISCOMs need modern technologies, better maintenance, and smarter systems to keep supply stable and uninterrupted. Improving reliability directly enhances consumer satisfaction and reduces technical and commercial losses.

Discussion Points

1. Strengthening network infrastructure – Upgrading feeders, transformers, and cables.
2. Smart meters & automation – Faster fault detection and restoration.
3. SCADA/ADMS – Real-time monitoring and control of distribution network.
4. Preventive maintenance – Thermography, health index, and condition monitoring.
5. Reliability indices – SAIFI, SAIDI, CAIDI improvement plans.
6. Load balancing – Feeder bifurcation, capacitor banks, and demand management.
7. Renewable integration support – Voltage regulation, flexible resources, and storage.
8. Consumer-centric measures – Helplines, outage information apps, and faster complaint resolution.
9. Electrical Safety and Reduction of Electrical Accidents
- 10.

Chair

CMD, REC

Presentation I

REC

Presentation II

BRPL

Moderator

CEO, BRPL- Panel Discussion (30 min) and Q&A (15 min)

Panelists

BESCOM, NPCL, IEX, GE Vernova, PowerXchange

Concluding Remarks by Chair of the Session

Session coordinator: Khajan Bardwaj, Director Technical, 7836810510, dirtech@aida-india.org
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Day 2 – 22nd January, 2026

SESSION 5: Renewable Consumption Obligations for DISCOMs

10:00 – 11:15 am

Session Background

Renewable Consumption Obligation (RCO) requires DISCOMs to ensure that a fixed percentage of the electricity they supply comes from renewable sources like solar, wind, hydro, and biomass. It is a key policy tool to push clean energy adoption, reduce carbon emissions, and meet national RE targets.

DISCOMs must procure RE power through PPAs, green energy markets, rooftop solar, or other mechanisms to meet these obligations. Non-compliance leads to penalties, higher costs, and regulatory scrutiny.

Discussion Points

1. Targets & Compliance – Annual RE % targets set by SERCs/GoI.
2. Procurement Options – Solar/wind PPAs, GTAM, green OA, rooftop solar, REC purchase.
3. Financial Impact – Cost of compliance vs. penalties for shortfall.
4. Challenges – Grid constraints, variability, high peak power costs, delays in projects.
5. Opportunities – Lower RE costs, green markets, BESS, hybrid RE projects.
6. Role of DISCOMs – Planning, scheduling, balancing, and timely RE procurement.
7. P2P Transactions of Rooftop Solar Energy

Chair	CMD, MSEDCL
Presentation I	CSEP
Presentation II	MSEDCL
Moderator	Milind Deore, Secretary, BEE- Panel Discussion (30 min) and Q&A (15 min)
Panelists	GESCOM, UPPCL, BEE, MNRE, KSERC, CSEP

Closing Remarks by Chair of the Session

Session coordinator: S. N. Kalita Director Regulatory Affairs, AIDA, 7002550205, dirra@aida-india.org
Sudhir Kumar, RO, AIDA, 9555232966, ro@aida-india.org

SESSION 6: Scaling up Demand Response

11:15 – 12:30 pm

Session Background

Demand Response (DR) allows consumers to reduce or shift their electricity usage during peak hours in response to signals from the DISCOM. It helps avoid overload, reduces costly peak power purchase, and improves grid stability. As renewable energy grows, DR becomes even more important for balancing supply and demand. Scaling up DR can significantly improve reliability, reduce costs, and make the grid more flexible.

Discussion Points

1. Why DR matters – Cuts peak load, avoids blackouts, reduces high-cost power.
2. Consumer participation – Incentives, rebates, time-of-day tariffs, smart appliances.
3. Technology enablers – Smart meters, automated demand control, mobile apps.
4. Industrial & commercial DR – Load shifting in factories, malls, cold storages.
5. Integration with renewables – Managing solar/wind fluctuations using flexible loads.
6. Policy support – Tariff reforms, DR programs under regulatory guidelines.
7. Challenges – Low consumer awareness, limited automation, data gaps.
8. Roadmap – Pilots, scalable platforms, real-time control, incentives for users.

Chair	Chairperson, CERC
Presentation I	AEEE
Presentation II	Tata Power Mumbai
Moderator	President, AEEE, Panel Discussion (30 min) and Q&A (15 min)
Panelists	MPPKVVCL (Jabalpur), MP Ensyatems Advisory Ltd., Schneider Electric India, AEW, TPDDL

Concluding Remarks by Chair of the Session

Session coordinator: Khajan Bardwaj, Director Technical, 7836810510, dirtech@aida-india.org
Garima Maurya, RO, AIDA, 9565950184, ro2@aida-india.org

12:30 – 12:45 pm Tea Break

SESSION 7: Capacity Building of DISCOMs Personnel

12:45 – 14:00 pm

Session Background

As the power sector becomes more digital, data-driven, and renewable-heavy, DISCOM staff must be trained in new technologies, modern systems, consumer services, and regulatory processes. Strengthening skills at all levels—technical, managerial, and operational—helps improve efficiency, reduce losses, enhance reliability, and deliver better customer service. Capacity building is essential to create a future-ready, tech-savvy workforce.

Discussion Points

1. Training needs – Smart metering, SCADA/ADMS, AI/analytics, AMI operations.
2. Technical upskilling – Grid operations, power quality, RE integration, safety.
3. Consumer services – Billing, grievance redressal, digital platforms.
4. Regulatory understanding – Tariffs, RCO/RPO, DSM, compliance requirements.
5. Leadership & management – Planning, decision-making, project management.
6. Digital literacy – Use of apps, dashboards, data analysis tools.
7. Institutional support – Training centers, partnerships with NPTI, IITs, ISGF, industry.
8. Outcomes – Better efficiency, reduced errors, improved reliability, stronger consumer trust.

Chair	Chairman, UPPCL
Presentation I	NPTI
Presentation II	GUVNL
Moderator	Director Regulatory Affairs, AIDA - Panel Discussion (30 min) and Q&A (15 min)
Panelists	KSEB, CESC Ltd. (Kolkata), IIT Delhi, ISGF, IGNOU, UPPCL, CESC

Concluding Remarks by Chair of the Session

Session coordinator: S. N. Kalita Director Regulatory Affairs, AIDA, 7002550205, dirra@aida-india.org
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CLOSING REMARKS

(14:00 -14:30 pm)

Concluding Remarks by Shri Alok Kumar (DG, AIDA)

Special Address by Shri Lokesh Chandra (CMD, MSEDCL)

Special Address by Dr. Ashish Kumar Goel (Chairman, UPPCL)

Session Coordinator: Sudhir Kumar, RO, AIDA, 9555232966, ro@aida-india.org
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14:30 – 15:30 Networking Lunch & End of Conference